

Source: *They Say, I Say*, by Graff and Birkenstein

TEMPLATES FOR WRITING SUMMARIES

To introduce a summary, use signal verbs (verbs that are more expressive than “she *says*” or “the author *believes*”) in a template like these:

In her essay X, she advocates a radical revision of the juvenile justice system.

They celebrate the fact that _____.
_____, he admits.

Here is a template that you can use to develop your summary:

X and Y, in their article _____, argue that _____. Their research, which demonstrates that _____, challenges the idea that _____. They use _____ to show _____. X and Y’s argument speaks to _____ about the larger issue of _____.

VERBS FOR INTRODUCING SUMMARIES AND QUOTATIONS

VERBS FOR MAKING A CLAIM

argue

assert

believe

claim

insist

observe

remind us

report

emphasize

suggest

VERBS FOR EXPRESSING AGREEMENT

acknowledge

do not deny

admire

endorse

admit

extol

agree

praise

celebrate

reaffirm

concede

support

corroborate

verify

VERBS FOR QUESTIONING OR DISAGREEING

complain

qualify

complicate

question

contend

refute

contradict

reject

deny

renounce

deplore the tendency to

repudiate

VERBS FOR MAKING RECOMMENDATIONS

advocate

implore

call for

plead

demand

encourage

exhort

recommend

urge

warn